

Stop Mice Coming Back Guide — Action Checklist

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INSPECT EXTERIOR ENTRY POINTS

- ☐ **Walk your home's entire perimeter and check where utility lines penetrate the foundation, because mice can squeeze through dime-sized gaps that are easy to overlook at ground level.:** Walk your home's entire perimeter and check where utility lines penetrate the foundation, because mice can squeeze through dime-sized gaps that are easy to overlook at ground level.
- ☐ **Inspect your garage door frame where it meets the concrete floor, especially at the corners, because the garage is the most common entry point and corners often have gaps wider than 1/4 inch.:** Inspect your garage door frame where it meets the concrete floor, especially at the corners, because the garage is the most common entry point and corners often have gaps wider than 1/4 inch.
- ☐ **Check all foundation vents for damaged screens, missing covers, or gaps at the edges, because vents provide direct access to your home's interior if they are compromised.:** Check all foundation vents for damaged screens, missing covers, or gaps at the edges, because vents provide direct access to your home's interior if they are compromised.
- ☐ **Examine the gaps where your plumbing vent pipes exit through the roof, because these openings at the roof line are often unsealed even when the vent cover itself looks intact.:** Examine the gaps where your plumbing vent pipes exit through the roof, because these openings at the roof line are often unsealed even when the vent cover itself looks intact.

SEAL INTERIOR PENETRATIONS

- ☐ **Look behind kitchen appliances like the refrigerator, stove, and dishwasher for gaps where pipes and wires enter the wall, because these hidden spaces are common mouse highways into your living areas.:** Look behind kitchen appliances like the refrigerator, stove, and dishwasher for gaps where pipes and wires enter the wall, because these hidden spaces are common mouse highways into your living areas.
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- ❑ **Inspect pipe penetrations through basement walls and floors and verify that floor drains have sealed covers, because mice can enter through any gap connected to your home's plumbing system.:** Inspect pipe penetrations through basement walls and floors and verify that floor drains have sealed covers, because mice can enter through any gap connected to your home's plumbing system.

- ❑ **Check bathroom exhaust fan openings and dryer vent connections for gaps between the duct and housing, because these fixtures often have large hidden openings that mice use to travel between spaces.:** Check bathroom exhaust fan openings and dryer vent connections for gaps between the duct and housing, because these fixtures often have large hidden openings that mice use to travel between spaces.

- ❑ **Replace worn or missing door sweeps and inspect weather stripping on all exterior doors, because even small gaps at door bases provide easy access for mice to enter your home.:** Replace worn or missing door sweeps and inspect weather stripping on all exterior doors, because even small gaps at door bases provide easy access for mice to enter your home.

TRACK ACTIVITY TO PRIORITIZE

- ❑ **Use a flashlight to identify fresh droppings near any gap you find, because fresh droppings that are dark, moist, and rice-grain shaped indicate the gap is actively being used by mice.:** Use a flashlight to identify fresh droppings near any gap you find, because fresh droppings that are dark, moist, and rice-grain shaped indicate the gap is actively being used by mice.

- ❑ **Look for urine pillars and dark rub marks along baseboards and wall edges, because these signs reveal established mouse highways even when no live mice are visible.:** Look for urine pillars and dark rub marks along baseboards and wall edges, because these signs reveal established mouse highways even when no live mice are visible.

- ❑ **Mark every gap you discover with painter's tape and record its location, because you need a complete list before deciding which gaps to seal first.:** Mark every gap you discover with painter's tape and record its location, because you need a complete list before deciding which gaps to seal first.

- ❑ **Seal active gaps with fresh droppings before inactive ones, because stopping the current flow of mice delivers faster results than sealing every gap indiscriminately.:** Seal active gaps with fresh droppings before inactive ones, because stopping the current flow of mice delivers faster results than sealing every gap indiscriminately.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.